



Moondrop CHU: Brilliant pair of earbuds for the price

My thoughts about these budget IEMs

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These days, wired earbuds are far and few among the products that show up at the Digit Test Centre. Much of this can be attributed to the rise of TWS earbuds in India. After the pandemic, there has been a surge in demand for wireless earbuds. Much of this has to do with smartphone manufacturers toning down the inclusion of 3.5 mm jacks on their devices. Now, this

increased the demand for these earbuds, which in turn increased the competition amongst manufacturers, which drove down the cost of these earbuds in the mass market. This circle of demand, supply, and competition has driven wired earbuds into a niche that a few explore.

So, when the Moondrop Chu wired earbuds showed up at the Digit Test Centre, everyone was intrigued. I spent a good amount of time with the earbuds, using them daily at home with my MacBook Air (M1, 2020). And

in this article, I bring to you my experience of using the Moondrop Chu wired earbuds.

Build and Design

Moondrop CHU earbuds are designed in the typical IEM fashion. The casing on the buds is metallic, giving it a robust feel. The in-line controls also carry the same metallic build and give these earbuds a sense of robustness which, when we consider the price of these earbuds at the time of writing, is awesome!

The wire has a translucent outer sheathing, giving them a nice look and feel, at the same time being robust. I put these earbuds through a LOT of challenging weather conditions and usage, but these refused to budge in terms of quality.

The angled 3.5 mm jack is gold plated and has very good tolerances, which again goes to show that these earbuds bring much more to the table than you would expect for this price.

As for the fit of these earbuds, the buds, due to their metallic casing, are a bit on the heavier side. But their design made them fit really well in my ears. I had to cycle through some of the included ear tips, but as soon as I got the right fit, the buds were snug in my ears. The fit helped with the overall isolation and sound leak from the buds. When I was out for my runs, the included ear hooks helped provide extra support and keep the earbuds in place. The control cluster, as I mentioned, had a robust build, and the buttons were also clicky and responsive.

Even during long periods of using the earbuds, I experienced minimal fatigue. The buds stayed in place for the most part, and when I needed external support, I put on the ear hooks, which were easy to mount and remove from the wires. The material used for the ear hooks was also soft rubber, which meant that I did not experience any irritation on the skin.

I passed these earbuds around amongst the folks at the Test Centre,